Timeline of the Dalai Lama's Life

1935 — Lhamo Thondup is born on July 6 to a farming family in the village of Taktser, Amdo Province, Tibet

1937 — The search party for the Fourteenth Dalai Lama visits Lhamo's home

1939 — Lhamo and his family take a three-month journey to Lhasa, the capital of Tibet, arriving on October 8

1940 — Lhamo is enthroned as the Dalai Lama at the Potala Palace on February 22

1950 — The Dalai Lama takes on full political power on November 17, after Chinese troops enter Tibet

1954–1955 — Visits China for peace talks with its leader, Mao Tse-tung

1959 — Flees Lhasa at night on March 17

— Arrives in India on March 31

1963 — Drafts a constitution for a more democratic government for the Tibetans in exile in India

1973 — Visits Western Europe for the first time

1987 — Visits the United States to announce his Five-Point Peace Plan to Congress in Washington, DC

1989 — Awarded the Nobel Peace Prize on December 10

2001 — Gives up some of his governing duties when Tibet holds its first democratic elections

2011 — Steps down as the political leader of Tibet and leaves governing to elected leaders